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History of Design:1850-Present
04/26/2019
Professor & Recitation leader: Finn Ferris

Too Fast to Live, Too Young to Die

"If punk birthed a thousand garage bands, it certainly birthed as many designers"

Said by Punk Curator Andrew Blauvelt

Punk, as known for its rebellious style on music creation, created a powerful subcultural phenomenon that transcended music to affect other fields such as visual art and design. Talking about Punk, we need to go back to the history when Punk was first aroused.

Back in 1970 in United Kingdom, the society is unstable in the sense of high unemployment rate (18-year-old youth average at 29% in 1977). Inflation rate even reached 10%. Strikes overwhelmed United Kingdom. Under this environment, Punk came to be being. Punk was antagonistic towards everything existed in the society especially the traditional rock music like the Doobie Brother, Pink Floyd, etc. In their music, they sarcasm not only music, but also consumerism, Nazi, abortion and typical visual arts and design and even everything that was considered traditional. The most famous band that brought up the term "Punk" is "Sex Pistols". Even though it only last for two and half years, it was the one who wakes the Punk beast that last for decades. This is a poster that done by Jamie Reid for Sex Pistol in 1979 called ***"The Great Rock 'n' Roll Swindle.*** It sarcasm the music industry as a "swindle" in which the artist is" the prostitute" and the record company "the pimp". Even though it was soon withdrawing by Virgin due to the American Express legal action, the approach towards punk rebellious style of posters remains in people's minds.

Another great example of Punk style poster is the ***Job Division, Unknown Pleasures*** done by Peter Saville at 1979. This poster was issued to promote Joy Division's debut album. It was a image rendering of successive waves emitted by a pulsar. Saville reversed the image from black-on-white to white-on black, conjuring

the dark atmospherics of the album's sound. This design has attained an iconic status and it is going so far as to spawn the term "Joyplot", which refers to a method of data visualization that involves the laying of successive and comparative histograms. It was created solely for the band's use. However, it has created a continuous effect on arts and even more, data science. It's narrow minded for us to only set the punk timeline at 1970 or 1980. Its lasting effects are still around us, in multiple fields.

There are no limits and preset regulations in ways of how Punk artists expressing their emotions and thoughts. However, this seems to become the rule that every Punk artist followed. They were bold in using of colors, materials, and fonts, etc. They made fun of everything that was conventional. Artists don't care about business, they don't care about politics. All they cared are their works. They wanted to express their dissatisfaction of what was happening at their decades. This is a poster done by unknown artist that sarcasm the nuclear war by pointing "New Clear days". Nuclear power's using was heavily discussed back in 20th century. Youth people didn't want to suffer the pains that the older generations left over. Simulating a scene of United Kingdom weather forecasting, this poster addressed the worry of United Kingdom might suffer from nuclear war in the future and it's hard to even find a clear day.

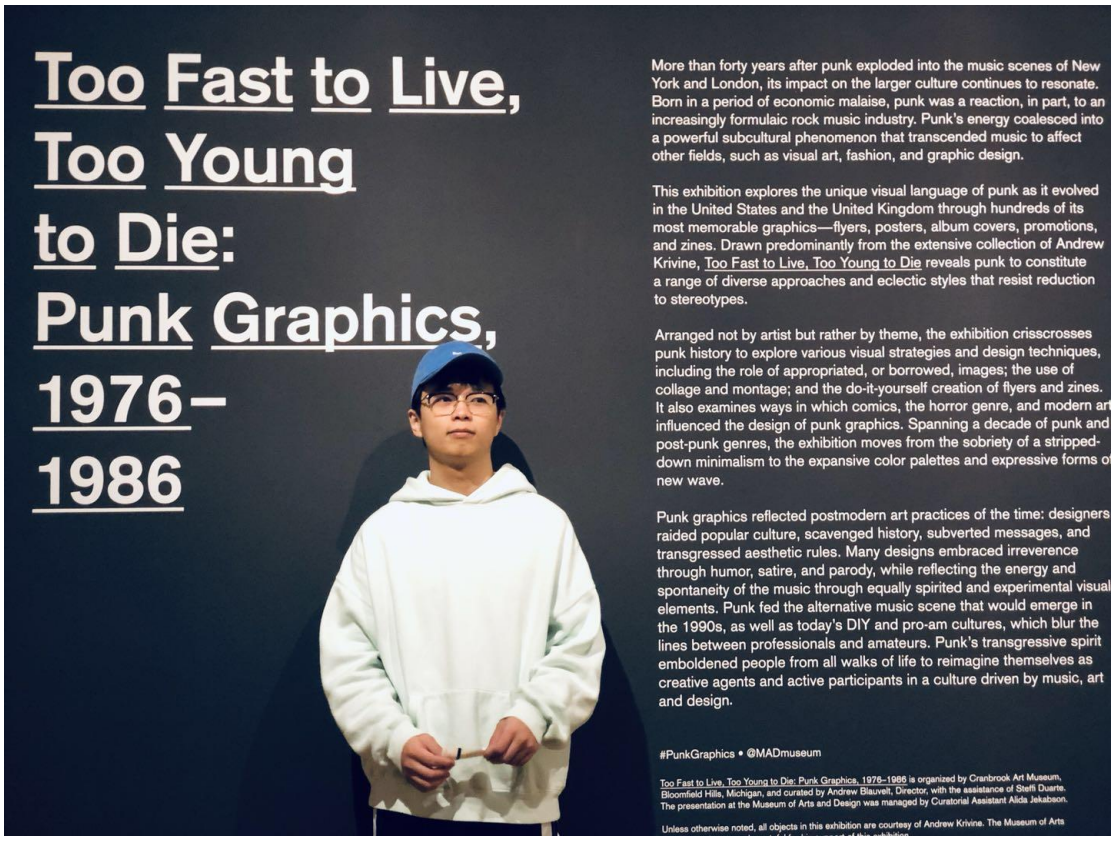
Punk thrived simultaneously as computer did. With the touching of new technology. Punk graphics also thrived on a basics of "cut and paste". It firstly started to use digital photos in artwork. Artists cut parts from newspaper, books, magazines and even more other sources. In this way the work they done is the visual equivalent of punk's improvised garage band sound, which also privileges amateur inventiveness and unfinished experiments over polished professionalism and perfected solutions. This artwork solutions continues now. Many graphic designers will extract different layers of photos or scripts from different sources and apply them to their own works digitally.

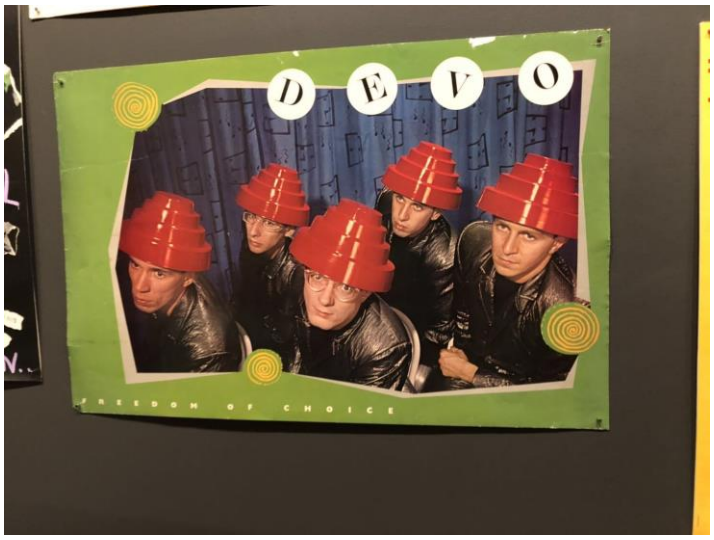
Even though punk is considered as a subcultural phenomenon and is not supposed to be recognized by the formal society, it has created its indelible impact not only in not only music, but also graphic design and also many other fields.

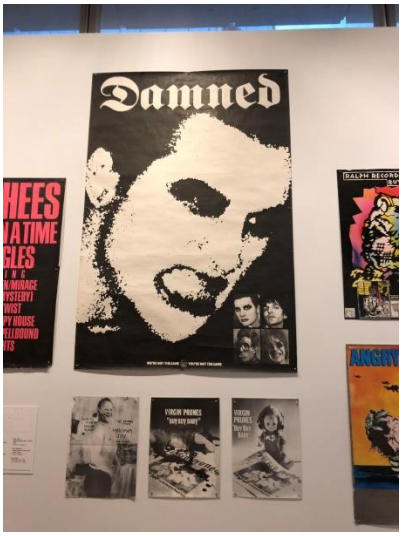
Edited: Post-Modern vs Punk
(Sorry professor, I missed this question,
I just found out after I finished the previous 2 pages)
compare one or two specific works to what you already know about Postmodern design. *Do they "fit"? How and/or how not?*

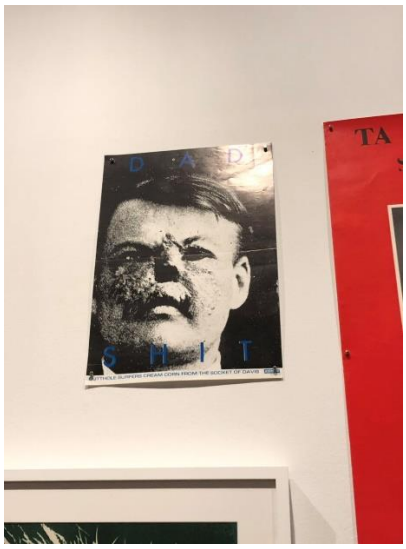
The postmodern object I want to mentioned is ***Ettore Sottsass's Carlton Bookcase***. And I want to bring in to comparison with the ***"The Very Best of Elvis Costello" Album cover.*** One very common aspect from them is they are all designing in a bold way. Sottass' bookcase reveals a deeply ant functionalist attitude through its premium on color, decoration and experimentation with form and surface. It utilizes a bold

combination of color: red, yellow, blue, green, light blue, black, etc. The Album covers by Elvis Costello are also very bold in using of colors and it didn't render a feeling that an album cover should have. Instead, it depicts several portraits of the singers in a way of self-mocking. It's not designing to give you any information as an album cover should have but more in an abstract way of demonstrating themselves. However, Punk's art was thrived in the need of album cover. Punk didn't cultivate anything particularly as an object. Instead, it focused on demonstrating artists' feeling through graphics. In that way, Punk's arts are more exciting and vivid. Postmodern design still plays a role of furniture design and interior design. Therefore, despite the fact many artists ignore that, practicality is still on the list that a design should consider. Moreover, many designs from postmodern design are continue being till today.


Too Fast to Live, Too Young to Die: Punk Graphics, 1976–1986
More than forty years after punk exploded into the music scenes of New York and London, its impact on the larger culture continues to resonate. Born in a period of economic malaise, punk was a reaction, in part, to an increasingly formulaic rock music industry. Punk's energy coalesced into a powerful subcultural phenomenon that transcended music to affect other fields, such as visual art, fashion, and graphic design.
This exhibition explores the unique visual language of punk as it evolved in the United States and the United Kingdom through hundreds of its most memorable graphics—flyers, posters, album covers, promotions, and zines. Drawn predominantly from the extensive collection of Andrew Krivine, Too Fast to Live, Too Young to Die reveals punk to constitute a range of diverse approaches and eclectic styles that resist reduction to stereotypes.
Arranged not by artist but rather by theme, the exhibition crisscrosses punk history to explore various visual strategies and design techniques, including the role of appropriated, or borrowed, images; the use of collage and montage; and the do-it-yourself creation of flyers and zines. It also examines ways in which comics, the horror genre, and modern art influenced the design of punk graphics. Spanning a decade of punk and post-punk genres, the exhibition moves from the sobriety of a stripped-down minimalism to the expansive color palettes and expressive forms of new wave.
Punk graphics reflected postmodern art practices of the time: designers raided popular culture, scavenged history, subverted messages, and transgressed aesthetic rules. Many designs embraced irreverence through humor, satire, and parody, while reflecting the energy and spontaneity of the music through equally spirited and experimental visual elements. Punk fed the alternative music scene that would emerge in the 1990s, as well as today's DIY and pro-am cultures, which blur the lines between professionals and amateurs. Punk's transgressive spirit emboldened people from all walks of life to reimagine themselves as creative agents and active participants in a culture driven by music, art and design.
#PunkGraphics • @MADmuseum
Too Fast to Live, Too Young to Die: Punk Graphics, 1976–1986 is organized by Cranbrook Art Museum, Bloomfield Hills, Michigan, and curated by Andrew Blauvelt, Director, with the assistance of Steffi Duarte. The presentation at the Museum of Arts and Design was managed by Curatorial Assistant Alida Jekabson.
Unless otherwise noted, all objects in this exhibition are courtesy of Andrew Krivine. The Museum of Arts


D E V O
FREEDOM OF CHOICE


Damned


D A D
S H I T

TOM ROBINSON BAND
STEEL PULSE & X-RAY SPEX
RALLY SUNDAY APRIL 30
11a.m.TRAFALGAR SQUARE
MARCH TO
VICTORIA PARK
Anti Nazi League
CARNIVAL!!!!
AGAINST THE NAZIS

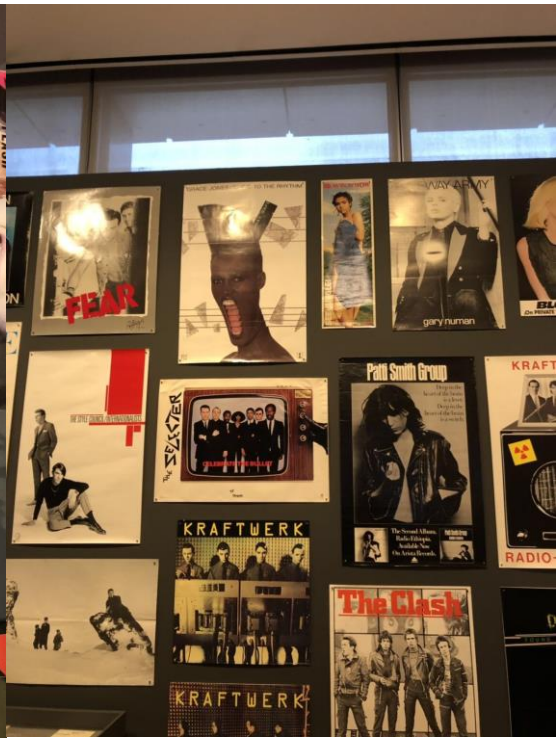
PETER AND THE
TEST TUBE BABIES
The JINX

IN MY HEAD
BLACK FLAG
BLACK FLAG
IN MY HEAD

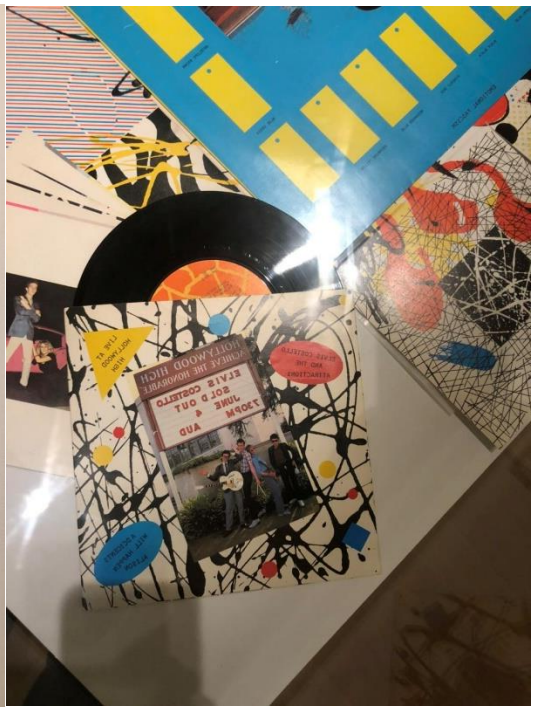
BLACK FLAG
MY WAR
OUT NOW!

LIVE
BAUHAUS

CRASH
SPLASH
N'DASH
WET 'N' WILD
THE FACE


FEAR
gary numan
Patti Smith Group
KRAFTWERK
KRAFTWERK
The Clash

NOW
XTC
drums and wires



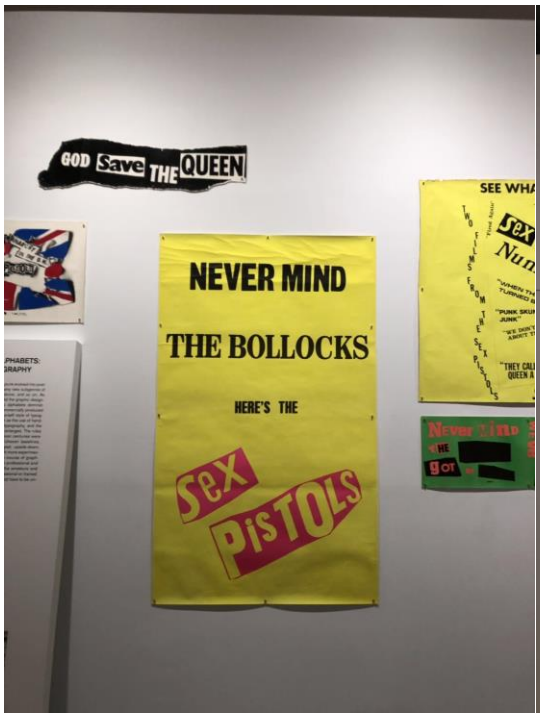
Paul and Steve
SEX PISTOLS
SILLY THING
POP CORN
pop
WHO KILLED
Bambi

HOLIDAYS in The SUN
SEX PISTOLS
A CHEAP HOLIDAY IN OTHER PEOPLES MISERY
VIRGIN RECORDS VS191

Albums to buy: RAMONES RAMONES LEAVE HOME ROCKET TO RUSSIA
MONDAY 8PM
1 OCTOBER
FREEBORN HALL
U.C. DAVIS, CA
GLENN BRANCA
THE BLANK GENERATION
B52's 急降下!
Nervus Rex
MARCH 22 AND 23
IRVING PLAZA
17 IRVING PLACE at 15th St. E.
475-9671
THE VOICE AND THE GUITAR, TOGETH
Robert Gord
w/Link Wray
FRI SAT DEC 29-30
MAX'S KANSAS CITY
CRAMPS
THE BASTARD
SNAKEFINGER
MAGIC TRAMPS
The New York Dolls
Aerosmith
G-Berlin
Michigan Palace

Elvis Costello
Ian Dury Wilko Johnson
Wreckless Eric
Nick Lowe
Lizzy Mercier Descloux

EXTRA POWER
CLASH
'I FOUGHT THE LAW'
NEW CLASH
THE COST OF LIVING E.P.


GOD Save THE QUEEN
NEVER MIND
THE BOLLOCKS
HERE'S THE
SEX PISTOLS

154
WIRE